Violet

Creativity · transcendence · sensitivity

Violet is a colour that never tries to blend in. It joins warm red and cool blue and both stay audible in it. It was the colour of emperors, priests and mourning, and of women who fought in it for the vote.

This page does not tell you what violet means. **It shows it to you from several sides**. How it is mixed, how it is painted with, where its reputation comes from, how it is read in different cultures and **what it can awaken in us**.

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How to mix the colour and its shades

One name, several forms. In optics *violet* is the colour at the end of the spectrum and *purple* (magenta-like) is a mixture of red and blue light that the eye completes. In everyday speech they are not distinguished, and in paint swatches you will find a range of different mixtures under the name “violet”. **There is no single violet.** For our card, imagine a colour between red and blue in which both stay audible.

Ready-made tubes have their charm, but **mixing violet will teach you the most**. You will see how cool blue and warm red pull against each other, and when the colour lights up or turns grey. Start small, on paper, and write down what came from what.

What to prepare

Blue
Pushes the mix towards a cooler, blue-violet form.

A cooler red
Brings the mix closer to a warmer, red-violet. Look for a red that is closer to pink than to orange.

Purple, or magenta
A vivid pink-red with which you mix brighter violets.

White
Creates lighter lilac and lavender tones.

Yellow
In a tiny amount it mutes violet.

Ochre
Mutes more gently than yellow and suits heathery tones.

Brown
Helps with earthier plum and aubergine mixes.

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How can you recognise it without technical names?

Violet is made by mixing blue and red, but **not every pair gives a radiant result**. If the red has a distinctly orange tint, the mix turns out muted to brownish, because yellow secretly joins in. For a brighter violet it is easier to try **blue with magenta**, or with a red that is closer to pink than to orange.

On the tube look for the mark **PV** (Pigment Violet) and a number. It tells you which pigment the ready-made violet is made from, even if names differ between makers. A ready-made violet from a tube and a violet mixed from blue and red often behave differently, so put them side by side as a test.

What the additions do



Blue

Moves towards blue-violet, cooler, closer to indigo.





Magenta or red

Moves towards red-violet, warmer and more sensual. Add by the tip of the brush.





White

Lightens into lavender and lilac. Add little by little, or start with white.





Yellow

Mutes into a quieter, slightly stormy tone. Really just the tip of the brush, otherwise the colour turns somewhere else entirely.





Ochre

A gentler muting than yellow, heathery and dusty tones.





Brown

Adds earthiness, plum and aubergine depth. Too much brown makes it a dirty grey.



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Ten violets to try

A part can be a drop or an equally sized heap of paint. **Take the ratios as a starting point**, because the strength of individual pigments differs. The ratios are approximate, so try them on paper first.

Basic violet



1 part blue + 1 part cooler red. *Fine-tune gradually according to the result.*

Brighter violet



1 part blue + 1 part magenta, *at first in roughly equal parts. Clean, rich, bold.*

Blue-violet



2 parts blue + 1 part magenta. *Calmer, cooler, closer to indigo.*

Red-violet



2 parts magenta + 1 part blue. *Warmer, more sensual, closer to pink.*

Lavender



4 parts white + 1 part blue-violet. *Delicate, dreamy, a little fragrant.*

Lilac



3 parts white + 1 part violet, a drop of magenta if needed. *Airy, springlike, soft.*

Soft heather



3 parts white + 1 part red-violet + a tiny trace of ochre. *Dreamy and a little autumnal.*

Plum



3 parts red-violet + 1 part darker blue, added gradually; possibly a trace of brown. *Full, deep, private.*

Aubergine



4 parts dark violet + 1 part brown. *Adjust the lightness as needed.*

Dusty grey-violet



2 parts violet + 2 parts white + a really tiny trace of yellow (the tip of the brush). *Quiet, elegant, a little stormy.*

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Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of seven colours violet stands after indigo, at the very end. In the current rainbow map of the chakras it is linked with the **seventh, crown chakra** and with the themes of **meaning**, **transcendence** and connection. Indigo may ask “what am I running out of?” and violet “what place does it have in my life?”

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root

Support, safety, presence. Ask yourself. What can I lean on?



Orange · sacral

Experiencing, pleasure, sensuality. Ask yourself. What does me good?



Yellow · solar plexus

Self-worth, will, decision-making. Ask yourself. What do I want to choose for myself?



Green · heart

Closeness, kindness, relationships. Ask yourself. Where can I be open and still stay with myself?



Blue · throat

Voice, expression, communication. Ask yourself. What do I need to say?



Indigo · third eye

Inner vision, intuition, discernment. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown

Transcendence, meaning, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me a wider sense of meaning?

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Sahasrara, the crown chakra

Chakras come from the Indian yoga and tantric tradition. The seventh chakra is called Sahasrara (“thousand-petalled”). It sits at the crown of the head. According to descriptions the lotus has 1000 petals, in about twenty layers. Pure consciousness and the calm from which the other chakras arise belong to it. Violet is linked to it only in today's popular view. In the classical texts the colour is given rather as many-coloured, and in the Buddhist tradition the crown chakra is white.

Its theme is **transcendence**, calm and a feeling of connection. For women this is often translated into questions. Do I feel part of something bigger? Can I be in silence? Do I have room for what cannot be explained?

When the chakra is open. You feel connected to the world and to yourself. You can be in silence without restlessness and you do not need to explain everything.

When the chakra is closed. The tradition describes a feeling of disconnection, emptiness or, on the contrary, a constant search for meaning. Closed does not mean wrong. It is just a signal that you may need to allow yourself room for **silence and transcendence**.

In today's view violet is the colour of this chakra. It serves you as a reminder and a support. It is not a treatment, it is an invitation to notice what does you good.

How to add violet when you lack calm and transcendence

- **Wear it**
  A lavender or plum scarf, jumper or dress. Something that gently surrounds you.
- **Put it in your home**
  A violet cushion, lavender in a pot, a dimmed lamp. A place where you can sit down.
- **Eat it**
  Plums, figs, aubergine or purple carrot. Slowly and without hurry.
- **Take it with you**
  A small amethyst, a lavender sachet or a violet hair band on your wrist. Discreetly in a pocket or on your hand.
- **Paint it**
  Soft areas that flow into each other, without a goal and without judging.
- **Give yourself a small thing**
  A violet pencil, hair band or mug just for joy.

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How to complement violet when you get lost in dreams

When there are already too many ideals in your world and too little grounding, you do not need more violet, but **earth**.

- **Add brown**
  Support and stability. Wood, natural materials, clay.
- **Add green**
  Nature and breathing. A plant, a walk, fresh air.
- **Add yellow**
  Light and lightness. A sunny accessory that brings you back into the day.
- **Finish one small thing**
  Ideas need finishing too. One finished piece a week carries more than ten half-made dreams.

This is **inspiration from tradition, not a treatment**. Try it gently and notice how you really feel afterwards.

Picture it with an example

You have a big change behind you. Something ended and practical matters are slowly settling. Yet a question stays in you. What now? What do I want to give time to? What is important to me even if others do not see it? Violet can accompany the moment when **you do not have to prepare a new plan right away**. First you allow yourself to find out where you actually want to turn.

Next to violet other colours can feel dreamier. Yellow makes it glow, green grounds it and white softens it. **These are possibilities of a personal reading**, not effects prescribed by colour combinations.

How to use this map

It is a way to sort out the themes you are living through. Do you start with violet but need to add green or brown? You can give it the meaning of needing **earth under your feet**. Do you add yellow? Perhaps you are drawn to step out of dreaming. **You choose the meaning**. The added colour does not diagnose your state.

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Free painting – intuition

When we paint freely, with no goal and no effort to make a pretty picture, violet often appears when we are looking for **something hard to name**. We do not always know why, though. Sometimes we know exactly why, sometimes not at all. Both are fine.

What can lie behind a violet stroke

The same violet area on paper can mean **something completely different each time**, depending on what is happening in us just then. That is why there is no point in reading a picture as a test with a single right answer.

Creativity and play.

Unusual shapes, bold combinations, a free movement of the hand. A colour that allows itself to be different.

Transcendence and silence.

Soft, scattered, light areas, often around the head or at the top of the paper. Something that cannot be grasped in words.

Longing and sensuality.

Soft, flowing lines, wine and plum tones. Warmth that does not hide.

Sadness and yearning.

Darker, cold areas, often low down, with slow strokes. Mourning that does not yet have words.

Pride and exceptionality.

Firm, striking shapes, often in the middle. A colour that wants to be seen.

Feeling different.

Violet alone among other colours, or an area that fits nowhere. A search for where my place is.

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Violet in a picture. Can it express what is happening inside?

Yes, it **can** – but it **does not have to**. When painting you sometimes reach for a colour before you can name what you feel. Violet can then give shape to the joy of trying, to silence, to sadness or to yearning. Equally it can simply be a **pretty colour** you happened to have at hand that day. It gains meaning only in connection with **your experience**. The colour itself does not know what happened to you. You do, or you will find out in time.

Art therapy also works with the idea that a picture can express something for which words are hard to find. What matters, though, is not one spot on the paper but the **whole picture** and how it came about. Your situation, memories, the movement of your hand and your feelings while painting. A predominance of violet alone **is not enough for a verdict** on whether it is depth or yearning. Maybe you wanted to allow yourself to be striking. Maybe the most beautiful tube simply fell into your hand.

What if I want to paint it but not wear it?

A picture and clothes may ask two completely different things of you. **A picture can bear your trial run** without you having to go shopping for it. On canvas you can give it enormous space and do not have to accept at the same time an idea of how you yourself will look in it.

Perhaps in it you allow yourself a boldness you do not yet want to show on your own body. Perhaps it is purely the difference between looking at a picture and wearing fabric. **When violet starts to delight you in clothing too, that will be fine.** And if not, it is not a required transfer of inner change into your wardrobe.

That is completely fine. Sometimes you want to wear it, sometimes only to paint it. Lilac on paper and a plum coat in a shop do not exclude each other, but they do not need to go together either.

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When violet takes over the space

First let your hand work. You do not have to paint a spiritual experience. When you reach for violet, **a universe, a mandala or a message does not have to appear**. It can happily become a large unnamed area. **The interpretation can wait.** And you do not have to choose the right reason before you touch the canvas.

Three things worth noticing

• QUANTITY

A large area or a small trace?

A large violet area can feel like something you want to sink into. It can also start to get too dense. A small trace can be precious, distant, or simply beautiful next to another colour. The amount of violet does not show the measure of your intuition or spirituality. What is interesting is how you feel next to that area. Do you want to stay, come closer, or step back?

• SATURATION

Velvet or air?

A dark plum has a different expression from a light lavender. When you add white, you are not necessarily "taking away depth". Maybe you are just looking for a form in which you feel more comfortable. Conversely, darkening can bring a feeling of fullness that was missing in the light picture.

• THICKNESS

Hold the mass or watch the translucency?

A thick layer can recall velvet or a solid wall. Thin paint spreads like ink and lets earlier layers show through. Notice which way of working draws you. You do not have to draw a conclusion about yourself from it.

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What to take from the picture

It does not matter what a violet stroke looks like. What matters is what you feel in it and what is happening in your life at that moment. **Two identical pictures can have completely different meanings**. One was made in the joy of your own courage, the other after a day when you felt different and abandoned. That is why you will not find a dictionary here, but **questions**.

A picture can speak even after time

Perhaps after a while you will notice that you returned to violet at a time when you lacked **transcendence**, **lightness** or the wish to be **different in your own way**. Perhaps you will connect it with a completely **different experience**. In self-reflective work inspired by art therapy a picture can serve as a trace of your own experience and a chance to look back.

Answers often do not come right away

Sometimes you look at what you painted and it tells you nothing. In a week, a month or a year it may suddenly dawn on you: “Aha, this is what I was carrying in myself then.” That is fine. **The picture will wait until you are ready to understand it.**

Neither is wrong and neither is right. **Violet can hold joy and yearning** and often both in one picture.

If very strong or painful feelings appear while painting, **do not stay with them alone**. Talk about them with someone close or with a therapist. **This page does not replace professional care**.

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Associations and stories

Our associations

Associations are the connections that form between us and a colour. We are not born with a ready-made list “violet = this”, and yet they tend to be surprisingly similar. They are mostly made of three layers, **from the body**, **from culture** and from **what we ourselves have lived through**.

From the body

Violet is **dusk**. The moment after sunset when the sky turns from orange to dark and the world softens. It is a colour of transition, and so it often gives us a feeling of something unfinished or open. At the same time it is the colour of lilac, lavender, grapes and plums, that is, the colour of **fragrant and sweet things**.

From culture

In Europe violet was long linked with power, the church and mourning. Today we often see it as the colour of **creativity, being different and femininity**. Violet is a colour that has several meanings at once and none of them denies the others. We look at this more closely in the chapter on cultures.

From what you have lived

Grandmother's lilac in the yard, a violet dress from childhood, a lavender field on holiday, a scarf from someone who is no longer here, or the violet wrapper of a chocolate handed out at festivals. These memories decide the most. **Two women can look at the same violet** and one feels joy, the other yearning.

When you know where your associations come from, it is easier to tell what is really “violet” and what is your story about it. You can ask yourself now. **What does violet connect with first for me, and where do I know it from?**

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Stories

Violet has several stories that are worth untangling. They show where the colour ends and where we begin.

The colour that cost more than silver

The word “purple” comes from the Greek **porphyra**, the name of a dye made from the mucus of sea snails of the genus Murex. The dye was already being made three thousand years ago in the Phoenician cities of Tyre and Sidon. Thousands of snails were needed for one gram. Friedländer in 1908 reports that **twelve thousand snails gave at most 1.4 grams** of pure dye. According to the Greek historian Theopompus it was sold in Colophon **at the weight of silver**. **For a long time violet was one of the most expensive colours in the world**.

The dye from the snails is chemically **6,6’-dibromoindigo**, that is, indigo with two extra bromine atoms. **Kings wore a colour that is chemically related to jeans.**

Roman magistrates wore a toga with a purple border and a victor an entirely purple one. In the 4th century AD only the emperor could wear it, and so the phrase “to put on the purple” meant **to become emperor**. In Byzantium a child born to a reigning emperor was called porphyrogennetos, that is, “born in the purple”. Today this is said of people born into wealth and privilege.

Mauve and the first artificial dye

In **1856** the eighteen-year-old chemist William Henry Perkin was trying to make artificial quinine against malaria and accidentally obtained a violet dye. At first it was called aniline purple, from 1859 mauve, after the French name for the mallow. Perkin patented it and built a factory. Between 1859 and 1861 mauve became a fashion that the magazine Punch made fun of. Violet, which once cost a fortune, was suddenly **available to almost everyone**. The dyes that grew out of this discovery created a whole branch of the chemical industry.

Suffragettes and half-mourning

In Britain and Ireland the suffragettes had three colours. **Violet** (loyalty and dignity), white (purity) and green (hope). Violet then became the colour of the women's movement in other countries too. **A colour can be a poster you wear on yourself**. It is no longer only about beauty but about **whose voice it is**.

In Victorian Britain relatives wore black for the first year after a death and then violet or dark green with black trimming. Violet was the colour of so-called **half-mourning**. In Thailand widows wear violet in mourning. **Violet is grief that is already beginning to lighten**.

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Emotions and feelings

The same violet can awaken **joy** in one of us and **yearning** in another, sometimes even both in one day. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experiences, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Wonder and the urge to create

Violet can bring **a wish to try things differently** and not to be afraid it will be **odd**. Ideas that come from nowhere, and the surprise that you enjoy what others did not choose.

And why?

Violet joins red (body) and blue (calm), and so it is often the colour of **combinations you would not look for at first glance**. Many makers have come to love it precisely because it **belongs nowhere**. It does not ask you to fit in, only to try.

Ask yourself

"When did I last do something differently from others?"

Desire and sensuality

Warmth in the body, a craving for **touch, voice and scent**. **A passion that does not need to announce itself** and is still noticeable.

And why?

Violet is close to red and pink. Surveys sometimes link it with eroticism and femininity. **Wine and plum tones** are the most common image of this. **Sensuality here does not have to be loud**, it can be private.

And what if I asked you now?

"What draws you, and you do not admit it?"

Pride and dignity

A feeling that I am **worth something** and that I matter. Sometimes **healthy pride**, sometimes fragile protection.

And why?

Violet was long the colour of emperors and then also of the women's movement. So it carries a feeling of **dignity**, but also of **claiming a place**. Especially dark and festive shades **can straighten your back**.

And try answering now

"What am I rightly proud of?"

Yearning and half-mourning

A quiet sadness that is **no longer sharp**. Memories that hurt more gently than before.

And why?

Violet was the colour of the passage of grief into the next period. In the Victorian era **half-mourning**, in Thailand the mourning colour of widows. **The sadness does not disappear here, it only changes** and grows a little **lighter**.

And now one question for you

"What are you missing today?"

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Feelings and experience

Deeper and slower states that settle in us. You often recognise them only after a while.

A feeling of being different

A feeling that **I do not fit in** and that nobody quite understands me. **Loneliness and pride at once.**

And why?

Violet is a colour of exceptions. It does not fit a traffic light, flags or ordinary uniforms. For some **freedom**, for others **solitude**. **It depends whether being different is your choice**.

Ask yourself

"Is my being different chosen, or did someone force it on me?"

Shyness about being seen

At home in front of the mirror violet pleases you, before you leave you take it off. **The colour has not changed, the idea of who will see you in it has.**

And why?

Looking at a colour is one experience. Knowing that others are looking at you in it is another. Violet can carry **a feeling of making a statement** even when you only wanted to put on a nice jumper. Sometimes a particular shade or cut does not suit you, and then **there is no need to look for a hidden story**.

And what if I asked you now?

"What would happen if nothing happened at all?"

Calm and transcendence

A feeling that there is **something bigger than what I see**. Wonder, silence, sometimes a light dizziness.

And why?

For centuries violet has been linked with the church, ritual and the sacred. In the yoga tradition it is linked with the crown chakra, although this link is newer than the chakra itself. Often **dusk**, a lilac in bloom or **music** is enough.

And try answering now

"When did I last feel part of something bigger?"

Dreaminess and distraction

You circle the same question, **depth turns into rumination** and a pleasant immersion becomes a **roundabout**.

And why?

There is too much depth when you move around the same thing for too long. Then do not add a deeper violet, another interpretation and another meditation. **Shrink the dark area, lighten the surroundings** or move to an activity where you meet your body and the world.

And now one question for you

"What would help you return to your body today?"

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My violet is not the same as your violet

The colour itself **experiences nothing**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the **experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes a **shortcut**. One glimpse is enough and the body knows whether it can relax or should pull back. That is why **your own reaction** is the most important.

- **Lilac**
  For one woman spring and grandmother, for another a funeral or a scent she cannot stand.
- **A violet dress**
  For one a festive moment, for another church, or a role she had to play.
- **Lavender**
  For one holiday and calm, for another a childhood wardrobe and the scent on laundry.
- **A violet bruise**
  For one an injury, for another just the colour after a fall that turns yellow in time.
- **Violet chocolate**
  For one a childhood reward, for another a reminder of something that is no more.

Why does it draw me when I actually do not feel like violet?

Perhaps it does not express how you feel. Perhaps you are drawn to what you **lack**. You have enough of what is immediately visible and audible, and you are drawn to something quieter and deeper that you do not have to explain at once. After a period when you mainly worked, cared or held everything together, a question can arise. **Who am I when I am not fulfilling any role?** Violet can accompany a need for privacy, imagination or a search for new meaning. It can also recall a garden from childhood or a favourite dress. Sometimes a **beautiful shade** simply stops you.

Why does it seem unpleasant to me, on the contrary?

A rich violet is **too heavy or sharp** for you. It reminds you of a ceremony, sadness, strictness or an environment in which you did not feel well. A dark room also looks entirely different from the same shade on a flower outdoors. A dislike of violet does not have to mean you reject beauty or depth. Perhaps you only reject a **particular memory**. Try to tell whether you mind all violet or only a certain form of it. Lilac can be beautiful even if you do not want a richly violet wall even in a photograph.

When to add it and when to take it away

Add it where it pleases you and opens something pleasant. Take it away when you catch yourself **hiding** in it, everything seems too mysterious or you finally want more light and people. Notice the changes. **Lavender does me good**, plum weighs on me. In a painting I want it big, in clothes I do not feel comfortable in it yet. We also put some colours aside. After a hard period we get rid of a dress or avoid a place. It is a way of protecting ourselves. And when we are ready, violet often comes back by itself, first as a scarf. These are your specific experiences. They do not have to fit into the single answer **“I like violet”**.

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Ask yourself

“Which sentence about violet is loudest in me? Whose is it really?”

Violet in cultures and traditions

Violet is a colour people have argued over for thousands of years. It cost a fortune, only a certain person could wear it, and it became a symbol of power as well as protest. Behind its reputation there are **more stories about money and power than about the colour itself**. Let us look at a few places and read them well.

This chapter therefore shows **two levels**. First, how violet is read in various **cultures**, and then how **traditional systems** look at it, which use it as an image.

Violet in different cultures

Phoenicia

The Phoenician cities of Tyre and Sidon made purple dye from the mucus of sea snails. Sources give the start of production around 1200 BC, some even earlier. Thousands of snails were needed for one gram of dye. Heaps of empty shells have been found near Sidon and Tyre.

From work, patience and rarity. The colour was expensive because it was hard to make.

The price and meaning of the colour rest on **labour, not on the colour itself**.

Rome and Byzantium

Roman magistrates wore a toga with a purple border and a triumphing victor an entirely purple one. In the 4th century AD only the emperor could wear it. In Byzantium purple was the imperial colour and “born in the purple” meant the emperor's son born during his reign. After the fall of Constantinople in 1453 purple lost its imperial status, but sources differ on exactly when production ceased (one gives the year 1204).

From costly production and laws that decided who could wear what.

When few people may wear a colour, **it becomes a sign of power**. When anyone may wear it, it turns into fashion.

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The Catholic Church

In the Latin rite violet is the colour of penance. Priests wear it at confession, in Advent and in Lent. Pope Paul II decided in 1464 that cardinals would wear scarlet instead of purple, and the cheaper violet remained for bishops.

From the fact that a colour that was a sign of imperial power was turned in the church into a colour of humility and expectation.

Violet can be **both noble and humble at once**. It depends on the context in which you meet it.

The Mixtecs in Oaxaca

On the coast of Oaxaca violet was made for centuries from a sea snail that the Mixtecs call tishinda. Unlike in the Mediterranean the snail was **not killed**. The dye was gently “milked” from it, the liquid was pressed onto yarn and the snail was returned to the tidal zone. The Mixtecs travelled to the coast for it only at a certain time of year and took care not to interfere with its reproduction.

From an indigenous craft and knowledge of the rhythm of nature. In the 1980s the snails were damaged by a company that paid fishermen to collect them in bulk. Today the snail is threatened by coastal development and poaching, and efforts to breed it have so far been in vain.

The same colour that elsewhere cost the lives of snails was here **a colour that spares its source**. Beauty can also have a gentle form.

Violet in traditional systems

Each tradition looks at violet **a little differently**, but all take it seriously. It is an old symbolic language and an inspiration, not a guide to healing.

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Traditional Chinese medicine

In the Chinese tradition there are five elements. Wood, fire, earth, metal and water. In the table of the five phases (Huainanzi) violet is given as **an intermediate colour of water**, the basic colour of water being black. It can also be understood as a mixture of fire (red, heart) and water (blue, kidneys). The tradition speaks of cooperation between heart and kidneys. Fire is cooled by water and water is warmed by fire.

This is my reading in the spirit of the tradition, not a classical assignment. Violet is thus an image of balance between passion and calm, body and depth.

How it relates to the colour violet. When you have too much fire in your life (stress, hurry, tension), a violet with a cool tint helps calm. When you have too much water (tiredness, fear, cold), wine and plum add warmth.

What you can take from it. Ask which is closer to you. Do you need to calm down, or warm up? According to the answer choose a cooler (lavender) or a warmer (wine) violet.

And what if I asked you now?

"What do you miss more today, cooling down haste, or warming up tiredness?"

Two situations in which it could help you

When you have faced outwards all day. You answer, explain, decide and sense the needs of others. In the evening you no longer want another conversation, but your head carries on without an audience. If violet feels pleasant to you, it can be part of a place where you handle nothing more. A picture, a soft fabric or a flower. **One stimulus instead of many.** What can it bring you? A moment in which you do not have to react. A violet cushion next to a constantly ringing phone will have a hard shift.

When you have been withdrawn into yourself for a long time. More quieting may not be what you need. Maybe you want to open a window, go out, meet someone or get moving. Leave violet in the picture and invite something livelier into the surroundings. A yellow flower, a warmer textile or daylight. You are trying to recognise whether you need to rest or to rejoin life. **The answer does not have to be the same every time.**

Traditional Chinese medicine uses the elements as an image. **It is not a diagnosis** and does not replace a doctor.

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Ayurveda

Ayurveda is an old Indian teaching about health. In it a person is described by three types of "energy", the so-called doshas. Vata (air, restlessness), pitta (fire, intensity) and kapha (earth and water, heaviness). Colours are chosen to balance what there is too much of. Opposites are treated with opposites. **Violet as a colour in its own right is not worked out in the classical texts.**

How it relates to the colour violet. Violet is made by mixing a warm red and a cool blue. That is why, according to modern interpretations, it can be adapted. **Light and cool calms, dark and wine-like warms.** Sources differ in the details, so take this as a direction, not a rule.

Pitta

This is how a purposeful, quick and thorough woman who flares up easily is described. Lavender and light violet calm her. The tradition recommends cooling colours.

- **Add lavender**
  Soft, cool, calming. In a bedroom or a work corner.
- **Add some cool**
  White and green, water, a walk by a river.

Vata

This is how an imaginative and quick but restless woman who is often cold is described. Cool light shades may be too cold for vata. A warmer plum and wine add warmth. **It is best to sense how you actually feel in it.**

- **Warmer shades**
  Wine, plum. Calm without chill.
- **Evening and sleep**
  Gentle shades and warm light.

Kapha

This is how a calm, firm and patient woman who easily becomes heavy is described. Dark cold shades may deepen the heaviness. The tradition recommends **lively warm colours**.

- **Orchid and wine**
  Warmer and livelier, as an accent.
- **Add warmth**
  Orange or yellow as a counterweight. A scarf, a tablecloth.

What is useful for us is that Ayurveda works with qualities. Movement and stability, lightness and heaviness, warmth and cold. A lighter violet can feel airy, a dark velvety one dense and enveloping. Once exactly this is pleasant, another time already too much. From a particular dosha I therefore **do not make a prescription for a colour**. If your surroundings feel heavy at a time when you want to be active, try lighter surroundings or a smaller area.

An internet test will not reliably determine your dosha. If it interests you more, consult a qualified Ayurvedic practitioner. It is not a treatment.

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A Jungian view

Carl Gustav Jung, the Swiss psychiatrist, understood colours as symbols that have two layers. A personal one (what we have experienced with the colour) and one shared by all people (images that repeat across ages and cultures).

Jung did not describe violet as a colour in its own right. He did, however, give colours for his four functions of the psyche. Thinking is white or blue and feeling is red. What I write next is my own reflection in the spirit of his idea, not Jung's statement about violet.

How it relates to the colour violet. If thinking is blue and feeling is red, violet could be the colour of the moment when they meet. **Not reason against the heart, but reason with the heart.** A moment when you know that you feel something and can also name it.

What you can take from it. When you live only in your head, red (feeling) may do you good. When feeling overwhelms you and you do not know what to do with it, blue (talking it out, naming it) helps. Violet is an invitation to put it together.

Jung did not want colours to become a dictionary. He himself said that correspondences change with the person and culture. The same violet can be joy for one woman and sadness for another. **We always ask what it means for you.** Jung's ideas about colours are a symbolic framework, not verified science.

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Feng shui

Feng shui is the Chinese art of arranging a space so that it is good to live in. In feng shui violet is **an intermediate colour of water** according to the classical table of the five phases. In some, especially Western, schools the south-east of the house map (bagua) is linked with wealth and abundance and violet and green are used for it. Schools differ on this, so take it as one possibility.

Violet is like lilac

A little gives a space depth and festivity, a handful turns it into theatre that quickly tires. The tradition takes it as a joining of fire and water, and so balances it with wood and greenery.

Simple tips

- **Start with one piece**
  For example a cushion or a flower (lavender, lilac) in a place where you will see it every day.
- **For every day**
  Soft shades (lavender, aubergine). Leave rich violet for small accents.
- **Natural materials**
  Combine it with wood, linen and wool.
- **Clothing**
  Violet in clothing is striking. When a rich one overwhelms you, try a lighter shade or a neutral accessory.
- **Festivity needs measure**
  Abundance does not have to mean six more cushions. Sometimes it is enough that you have somewhere comfortable to sit.
- **Try fabric first**
  Before you repaint a room, try a throw or a larger sample and look at it in the morning and in the evening.

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What people say and what holds true

MYTH Violet has always been the colour of kings.

TRUTH Tyrian purple was obtained from sea snails and was very expensive, which is why it became linked with power. Since 1856, when William Perkin discovered the first synthetic violet dye, it has also become a fashion for everyone.

MYTH Violet brings wealth.

TRUTH Some schools of feng shui put it in the south-east, the zone of abundance. Recommendations differ and the colour guarantees nothing.

MYTH Violet in the bedroom is ideal because it calms.

TRUTH A muted lilac or lila can be pleasant. A rich violet in a small dark room rather weighs down. How you fall asleep in it decides.

What to pair violet with

- **Cream and warm white**
  A lighter and softer whole.
- **Wood and linen**
  A more natural, less festive impression.
- **Green**
  It recalls a flower among leaves, just watch the proportion and richness.
- **Yellow or ochre**
  A striking lift that can be enough in a small area.
- **Pink**
  A softer or more sensual expression depending on the shades.
- **Grey and gold**
  Grey looks elegant. Gold gives festivity, but in excess it drowns out ordinary comfort.

Elements

- **Water and fire**
  Violet joins them. Take care that neither outweighs the other.
- **Wood and greenery**
  Plants and wood ground violet.
- **Metal**
  Gold and silver add shine, but in a small amount.
- **Earth**
  Clay and linen soften the festive impression.

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Feng shui room by room

What works, what to watch for and a simple tip.

Living room

What works. A violet cushion, throw or picture. It works as an accent, not as a whole wall. A plum armchair or a muted throw can give a light living room a striking centre.

What to watch for. In a small, poorly lit room with dark furniture, further deep areas can strengthen a heavy impression. Try a light fabric first or fewer decorations.

A simple tip. Velvet and wool add depth and warmth to violet, glossy satin makes it more festive and cooler. Matte linen calms it.

Kitchen and dining room

What works. Violet can work in ceramics, textiles or on a smaller piece of furniture. Next to wood and a light base it looks distinctive.

What to watch for. Try a large dark area in a small kitchen first. I would not use violet light as the main lighting for food, because it changes its look.

A simple tip. Matte ceramics and glass in violet look light and playful. A glossy dark kitchen run, on the other hand, floods the room.

Bedroom

What works. Lavender or muted lilac can be pleasant in textiles. A deeper plum can feel intimate and sensual, if you perceive it that way. **Try it in fabric first**, you will easily tell whether it pleases you in the morning and in the evening, and you can put it away again.

What to watch for. Dark violet walls often feel heavy. If the whole feels cold to you, add a warmer neutral shade, wood or a soft material.

A simple tip. Cotton and linen in lavender feel airy, velvet in plum envelops you more. Notice how the textile feels under your hand as you fall asleep.

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Children's room

What works. A soft lavender can be calm. Violet can be a favourite, but it does not have to rule everything from ceiling to slippers. Try it in accessories that can be changed.

What to watch for. A rich violet for children often seems too serious. The colour alone does not decide whether a child will be calm, focused or sleep well. Light and the amount of things in the room matter too.

A simple tip. The child is the inhabitant of the room. Her own experience of the colour matters more than a general rule. A soft violet blanket or a plush toy often means more to children than the colour of a wall.

Study

What works. Violet supports creativity in small doses. It can be a personal choice for a corner where you read, design or paint.

What to watch for. One that is too rich tires the eyes. When its area disturbs you, move it out of the main view and give the workspace lighter surroundings.

A simple tip. Matte paper, wood or linen leave violet in the background. A glossy rich area highlights it, but can tire the eyes.

Hall and entrance

What works. The hallway is often the least lit room in a flat. Keep the walls light and put violet into small things. A flower, a picture or a rug. It is the first greeting that welcomes you at the door.

What to watch for. Dark shades lower the light. If your entrance feels gloomy, try better light or a lighter wall before another dark accessory.

A simple tip. A rug or hooks made of natural materials in soft violet welcome you. Glossy dark surfaces shrink the space even more.

Try asking yourself

“Why do I want violet at home? What should it bring me, calm, creativity or abundance?”

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Colour frequency and phototherapy

With violet the expression “high vibrations” often appears. It sounds as if some women were equipped to receive it and others still had to buy a better antenna. A violet fabric **reflects** part of the light, a violet lamp **emits** light. Let us say what of this is **atmosphere** and what is already **treatment**.

And this is exactly where it is good to leave **miraculous promises** aside. Violet light is **not a key to a chakra** or a cure for hormones and mood.

What does “high frequency” mean?

In physics spectral violet light has a higher frequency than red. But that is not a scale of spiritual maturity or an explanation of why someone minds a violet jumper. The shades we commonly call violet also do not have to represent a single frequency. A violet impression can also arise from a combination of red and blue components. Under ordinary lighting, fabric mainly reflects part of the incoming light. **By itself it is not a transmitter of any special spiritual energy.**

Your reaction to violet does not lose value because of this. We just do not need to explain it by saying that your body “cannot handle its frequency”. It can **attract** you, **occupy** you, feel **deep**, or **unsettle** you. That is an exact description of an experience and it does not need physics.

What you can try at home

A lamp that looks violet can create the colour in various ways, for example by combining red and blue light sources. Try it first **weaker, indirect and only in part of the room**, for example with music, rest or your own ritual. **What it can bring you.** A different atmosphere from an ordinary lamp. If it makes you squint, makes it harder to see, or the light disturbs you, go back to ordinary pleasant lighting. There is no need to get used to it in the name of a spiritual benefit.

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Where light is really studied

Violet and ultraviolet are not the same

Ultraviolet radiation **is not visible**. A visibly violet look of a device does not by itself say what radiation it uses or what effect it has. In dermatology some precisely defined kinds of UV radiation are used, for example in the treatment of **psoriasis**, but the dose and suitability belong to the particular treatment procedure. That cannot be turned into a recommendation to shine a violet bulb at home.

Chakras and hormones

Ordinary violet lighting has no proven ability to open the crown chakra or to treat psychological or hormonal difficulties. For atmosphere follow your own pleasant experience. For treatment you need a specific method and professional advice. If you are looking for light treatment of a skin problem, a suitable first contact is a dermatologist.

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Astrotype and colours

Are you Libra, Sagittarius or Pisces? The astrotype is a much broader topic than just the sun sign. If you really want to go into **depth**, knowing only your date of birth is not enough. The exact place and time of birth are also important, because only from them are the ascendant, the position of the Moon, planets and other parts of the horoscope calculated. Here, though, we stay only at the edge of what relates to colours.

According to astrological tradition violet is most often linked with the planet Jupiter. Wisdom, expansiveness and faith. In other sources you will also find it with the Moon, the Sun, Mercury and Venus. Traditional sources differ on this, so take it as inspiration. Depending on how the planet of your sign relates to violet, it may feel close to you or distant. Find your sign (dates are approximate, they change by year) and read what violet may say to you.

The ascendant is the sign that was rising on the eastern horizon at the moment of your birth. According to astrological tradition it shows how you come across outwardly and how you enter the world, while the Sun sign describes more who you are inside. For each sign you will therefore find not only its character but also a short note on how the colour fits when it is your ascendant.

Aries (21 March – 19 April)

Your violet

Brighter violet · red-violet · plum

A violet that **gives you courage** to be striking even where nobody expects it.

Aries is linked in astrology with Mars, fire and the start of spring. It is quick and direct. Violet is unexpected for it, neither red nor blue. It gives you **courage to be different** without slowing you down.

What Aries is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality cardinal · ruler Mars

Aries opens the zodiac and you can tell that it is first. It is a **pioneer** who gets into things before thinking them through perfectly. It is direct, impatient and likes to compete. It gets angry quickly but forgives quickly too.

Its strength is the **courage** to begin. Weaker is perseverance in long, slow matters. It does best where something is happening and where it can act at once.

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What it can support in you

Violet can support moments when you want to show your own style even where others do not expect it. It suits where your courage is faster than regard for someone else's opinion.

With Aries, strength is often in the first step. A brighter violet can add **individuality** to it.

Shadow provoking just for effect

In the shadow Aries reaches for a striking colour in order to hit someone, not because it enjoys it.

Aries likes to act quickly and clearly. Violet can seem vague, because it is neither red nor blue.

And when you mainly want to provoke a reaction, the expression stops being yours and becomes a weapon.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **ask whether you wear it for yourself** or for other people's eyes.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mars red as an accent.

red · lipstick red · iron

Lipstick, a scarf or an accessory add body and spark so that violet is not just an idea. Iron as a metal.

Aries as ascendant

When Aries is your ascendant, you come across as direct, lively and decisive. People may see you as someone who gets straight to the point, and the first impression tends to be brisk.

Violet adds an unexpected gentleness to you. Brighter shades suit you more than aubergine.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for moments when you want to **try something differently** than you are used to.*

When you are too fast, put one violet thing on your desk. It reminds you that expression can be dosed even with verve.

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Taurus (20 April – 20 May)

Your violet

Plum · lavender · red-violet

Violet as **velvet, silk and the scent of lavender**.

Taurus is an earth sign linked with Venus, the senses and stability. Violet suits it as a material, not as an idea. In velvet, silk or the scent of lavender it can feel **luxurious and calm**.

What Taurus is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality fixed · ruler Venus

Taurus is an earthy, **patient** and sensual sign. It likes good food, pleasant materials, nature and security. It gets going slowly, but once it decides on something, it persists.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to enjoy the present moment. The weaker side tends to be stubbornness and finding it hard to let go of what is familiar.

What it can support in you

Violet can support the joy of touch, scent and beautiful things. It suits where you want comfort with a touch of festivity.

With Taurus it is often not only about the colour but about the material. Plum on wool or velvet looks entirely different from glossy synthetic.

Shadow showiness as security

In the shadow Taurus surrounds itself with beautiful things in order to feel safe. Splendour then replaces the certainty you do not allow yourself to find inside.

Taurus likes the security of nature. A violet that is too rich or artificial can seem showy.

And when luxury becomes a shield, it is hard to tell what really does you good.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **choose one thing that pleases you to touch** and leave the others be.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Venus green or white.

green · white · copper

Copper and natural materials add earthiness so that violet is not only festive.

Taurus as ascendant

When Taurus is your ascendant, you come across as calm, stable and pleasant. You build trust slowly and people often feel firm ground in you.

Violet gives your calm impression depth and sensuality. Plum suits more than a sharp one.

In everyday life

*Take something violet you like in your hand and notice how it feels under your fingers. That is your **violet**.*

*Lavender in a pot or a velvet cushion. **Treat yourself.***

Gemini (21 May – 20 June)

Your violet

Lilac · brighter violet · blue-violet

A violet that lets you **try, combine and change**.

Gemini is linked with Mercury, movement and curiosity. They are playful and like to skip about. Violet is a colour that belongs nowhere, and that is why it suits you. You can **play** with it and promise it no loyalty.

What Gemini is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Gemini is **curious**, talkative and adaptable. It learns quickly, likes to tell stories and enjoys it when a lot is going on around it. It can see several sides of one thing.

Its strength is **lightness** and wit. The weaker side tends to be scatteredness and a tendency to start more things than can be finished.

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What it can support in you

Violet can support ideas that come from different directions. It suits details, patterns and small things you can change according to your mood.

With Gemini strength is often in playfulness. Lighter lilac and lavender keep it light.

Shadow masks one over another

In the shadow Gemini tries on ever new roles until it is no longer sure which of them is its own.

Gemini likes to skip about. A deep violet can seem too serious or dramatic.

And when play turns into escape, another expression brings nothing new.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **keep one thing on for a longer time** and notice how it feels to live with it.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury orange or blue.

orange · blue · cream

Patterns and small details give play a structure so that it does not stay only in the head.

Gemini as ascendant

When Gemini is your ascendant, you come across as lively, friendly and chatty. People may see you as curious and youthful, even if inside you are perhaps calmer.

Violet adds a mysterious touch to your playfulness. Lilac shades are light and do not force you to stay.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for **small things** you can change easily. A scarf, a pencil, an ornament.*

When you are scattered, try one violet place where you stop. For example a flower on the table.

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Cancer (21 June – 22 July)

Your violet

Lavender · dusty grey-violet · soft heather

Violet as **gentle protection** and a space for dreams.

Cancer is linked with the Moon, water and summer. It is sensitive and caring. Violet gives it **a soft cover** and a place where it may dream. It suits fabrics that caress and scents that recall home.

What Cancer is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality cardinal · ruler Moon

Cancer is **caring**, sensitive and strongly connected to home and family. It has a good memory for feelings and relationships. It enters the world cautiously, much like a crab with its shell.

Its strength is **empathy** and the ability to create safety. The weaker side tends to be changeable moods and a tendency to withdraw when it feels hurt.

What it can support in you

Violet can support moments when you need to withdraw and gather strength. Lavender and heather are quiet but kind.

With Cancer strength is often in care. Violet can remind you that you can also care for yourself.

Shadow escape into memories

In the shadow Cancer lives more in what was than in what is. Violet then becomes the colour of what is no more.

According to tradition violet is the colour of the passage of grief. When yearning returns, it can remind you of what is no more.

And when you wrap a memory too softly, it is hard to let go.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **allow yourself to grieve**, and then open the window and let the light in.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add moon silver and white.

silver · white · sage

Soft fabrics and silver jewellery give violet lightness and light.

Cancer as ascendant

When Cancer is your ascendant, you come across as gentle and careful. At first you keep your distance, but then warmth unfolds and people see in you someone who will look after them.

Violet on you looks like a soft shawl. Dusty shades suit you more than a rich one.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for the **evening**, when you want to quiet down. A lavender cushion or a candle.*

When yearning floods you, put a violet thing next to the window. Let the light brighten it a little.

Leo (23 July – 22 August)

Your violet

Brighter violet · plum · red-violet

Violet as a colour **worn by kings**.

Leo is the king of the zodiac, linked with the Sun, fire and summer. Violet is the colour of kings and you can wear it **with the same assurance**. Festive shades give you dignity without your having to show it off.

What Leo is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality fixed · ruler Sun

Leo is **generous**, proud and creative. It likes to give, likes to rejoice and needs others to see and appreciate it. It is loyal and has a big heart.

Its strength is **warmth** and the ability to inspire others. The weaker side tends to be sensitivity to criticism and a tendency to want to be the centre of attention.

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What it can support in you

Violet can support moments when you want to be seen in your own way. It suits festive occasions and striking accessories.

With Leo strength is often in pride. Plum and wine keep it warm.

Shadow showiness that overshadows your own light

In the shadow Leo adorns itself with so many marks of grandeur that it can no longer be seen itself.

Leo wants to shine. A violet that is too rich can compete with your light, or seem showy.

And when the colour becomes a costume, it is harder to take off.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **choose one striking piece** and keep the rest simple.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add sun gold and yellow.

gold · yellow · cream

Gold as an accessory. The Sun adds warmth to violet and a reason for you to smile.

Leo as ascendant

When Leo is your ascendant, you come across as self-assured, warm and striking. You enter a room in a way that people notice you even when you do not want them to.

Violet gives your self-confidence a noble touch. Gold next to it makes the impression warmer.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for moments when you want to feel **dignified** without having to prove anything.*

When you shine too much, add something simple to violet. Let the person be seen too, not just the clothing.

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Virgo (23 August – 22 September)

Your violet

Lavender · lilac · grey-violet

A violet that feels **clean and calm**.

Virgo is linked with Mercury, earth and the end of summer. It likes order and clear lines. A pale lavender suits it like **a clean sheet of paper** bearing only a delicate trace of colour.

What Virgo is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Virgo is **meticulous**, attentive and practical. It notices details that others overlook and likes to be useful. It tends to be modest and judges itself more strictly than others.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to improve things. The weaker side tends to be perfectionism, worries and a tendency to criticise itself.

What it can support in you

Violet can support calm in an environment where everything is in its place. Lavender and lilac look fresh, not disturbing.

With Virgo strength is often in attention to detail. Violet in a small dose enriches it with a gentle tone.

Shadow vagueness that gives no peace

In the shadow Virgo examines where blue ends and red begins, and cannot stop.

Virgo notices every small thing. Violet seems vague. Where does blue end and red begin? That can disturb.

And when attention turns into watching over, the colour stops being a rest.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **choose a shade that feels pleasant** and stop dissecting it.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury blue or white.

blue · white · light grey

Clear lines and clean shapes give violet order so that it stays calm.

Virgo as ascendant

When Virgo is your ascendant, you come across as neat, restrained and reliable. People see you as observant and sensible, sometimes even overly reserved.

Violet adds a soft touch to your carefulness. Light shades keep clarity.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for **a small calm place**, such as a bottle, a notebook, a flower.*

When order overwhelms you, put one sprig of lilac or lavender on your desk. It does not have to be perfect.

Libra (23 September – 22 October)

Your violet

Basic violet · lavender · red-violet

A violet that **reconciles red and blue**.

Libra is linked with Venus, air and the start of autumn. It seeks balance. Violet reconciles red and blue and in it you can find **your own balancing**.

What Libra is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality cardinal · ruler Venus

Libra longs for **harmony**, beauty and justice. It is diplomatic, sociable and has a feel for aesthetics. It lives best in relationships in which it does not feel alone.

Its strength is **tact** and the ability to see both sides. The weaker side tends to be hesitation and a tendency to avoid conflict even when it would help.

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What it can support in you

Violet can support moments when you look for harmony between two sides. It suits an environment where you need to decide calmly.

With Libra strength is often in a sense of beauty and measure. Violet can help you keep both.

Shadow hesitating between two poles

In the shadow Libra sees two colours in every violet and cannot choose which should win.

Libra hesitates. Violet can increase the hesitation. It is neither warm nor cold.

And when you want to please everyone, you stop listening to yourself.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **decide by your first feeling** and then give that decision a day.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Venus green or white.

green · white · copper

Copper as an accessory. Green and white add a clear point to lean on.

Libra as ascendant

When Libra is your ascendant, you come across as elegant, pleasant and balanced. People like you for your tact, even if inside you take a long time to decide.

Violet adds depth to your charm. Basic violet keeps the balance.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for **pairs**. Two cushions, two flowers. A balance you can see.*

When you hesitate, take a violet thing in your hand and say aloud what you want.

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Scorpio (23 October – 21 November)

Your violet

Plum · aubergine · red-violet

A violet that **hides and glows at once**.

Scorpio is linked with its traditional ruler Mars, water and autumn. It loves depth and mystery. Plum and wine violet suit it, **hiding and glowing at once**.

What Scorpio is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality fixed · ruler Mars, in the newer view also Pluto

Scorpio is **intense**, deep and loyal. It feels strongly, but does not always show it. It dislikes superficiality and likes to get to what is hidden.

Its strength is **determination** and the ability to transform. The weaker side tends to be distrust, jealousy and a need to keep things under control.

What it can support in you

Violet can support moments when you need to dive in. It suits an environment that does not want to explain everything.

With Scorpio strength is often in intensity. Dark shades can bear it without suppressing it.

Shadow jealous secrecy

In the shadow Scorpio wraps itself so thoroughly that nobody can see what it hides. And it feels that nobody can see it.

Scorpio loves intensity. Shades that are too dark can be heavy and closed.

And when secrecy becomes a habit, it is harder to tell privacy from protection.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **find one person you tell something to**, and a lighter shade as a counterweight.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add a light lavender tone and Mars red.

lavender · red · cream

A light tone relieves the depth. Red adds a warmth that needs no explanation.

Scorpio as ascendant

When Scorpio is your ascendant, you come across as focused, mysterious and strong. People sense the intensity of your gaze and often feel that you know more than you say.

Violet adds mystery to your allure. Deep shades suit you, just thin them with light.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for **private moments** when you do not have to explain anything.*

When darkness floods you, open the window. A violet dusk is beautiful, but morning comes even without your help.

Sagittarius (22 November – 21 December)

Your violet

Blue-violet · brighter violet · lavender

Violet as a colour of **wisdom and soaring**.

Sagittarius is linked with Jupiter, fire and autumn. According to some sources violet is the colour of your ruler, and is connected with **wisdom, soaring and faith**. It is one of the colours linked with Sagittarius in tradition.

What Sagittarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter

Sagittarius is **optimistic**, open and free-spirited. It loves travel, new experiences and the search for meaning. It speaks honestly, sometimes a little too directly.

Its strength is **enthusiasm** and faith in a good outcome. The weaker side tends to be impatience with detail and a tendency to promise more than can be managed.

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What it can support in you

Violet can support moments when you want to look further than the next corner. It suits where generosity is needed.

With Sagittarius strength is often in perspective. Blue-violet keeps both distance and warmth.

Shadow loftiness that tears you from people

In the shadow Sagittarius gazes into the distance so intently that it stops seeing who stands beside it.

Sagittarius longs for freedom. Violet can seem too lofty and binding.

And when you turn wisdom into lecturing, the colour changes into a uniform.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **ask others what they see** and believe that both truths can hold.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Jupiter blue and green.

blue · green · tin

Tin as a metal. Blue and green draw the eye back to the earth.

Sagittarius as ascendant

When Sagittarius is your ascendant, you come across as open, jovial and adventurous. People see you as someone with a wide outlook and an appetite for discovery.

Violet adds depth to your optimism. Blue-violet keeps the perspective.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for **travelling and planning**, for example a passport cover or a notebook of ideas.*

When you soar too high, add green to violet. A plant on the desk is enough.

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Capricorn (22 December – 19 January)

Your violet

Plum · aubergine · grey-violet

A violet that **carries dignity**.

Capricorn is linked with Saturn, earth and winter. It likes seriousness. A dark plum is close to black and carries **dignity** without having to prove anything.

What Capricorn is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality cardinal · ruler Saturn

Capricorn is **responsible**, goal-oriented and disciplined. It likes to build and is not afraid of a long road. It has a dry sense of humour and shows it only to those it trusts.

Its strength is **perseverance** and the ability to see things through. The weaker side tends to be strictness with itself, reserve and a tendency to put joy off until later.

What it can support in you

Violet can support moments when you want to seem firm and gentle at once. It suits an environment where care is valued.

With Capricorn strength is often in perseverance. Dark shades accompany it without noise.

Shadow sensitivity held back under armour

In the shadow Capricorn armours itself so that it has no way to let in either joy or tenderness.

Capricorn is practical. Violet may seem too sensitive or impractical to you.

And when sensitivity hides, the colour does not find it, it only reminds you of it.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **allow yourself one gentle thing** and not explain it.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Saturn black or grey.

black · grey · light wood

Matte materials keep violet sober. Wood warms it.

Capricorn as ascendant

When Capricorn is your ascendant, you come across as serious, mature and reserved. People may see you as older than you are, and only later discover how funny you are.

Violet adds tenderness to your seriousness. Dark shades suit you, just add a light point to them.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for **important moments**. A scarf or tie that holds you.*

When you are too strict, allow yourself a drop of lavender. It will not harm your order.

Aquarius (20 January – 18 February)

Your violet

Brighter violet · blue-violet · lavender

A violet that **does not fit in**, and that is why it suits.

Aquarius is linked with its traditional ruler Saturn, air and winter. It likes originality. Violet is a colour that does not fit in, and that is why it can **suit** you.

What Aquarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality fixed · ruler Saturn, in the newer view also Uranus

Aquarius is **independent**, original and idealistic. It is interested in ideas, humanity and the future. It wants to go its own way and does not like adapting to expectations.

Its strength is **perspective** and the ability to come up with new things. The weaker side tends to be distance from feelings and a tendency to withdraw when there is too much closeness.

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What it can support in you

Violet can support moments when you want to go your own way. It suits a striking detail that sets you apart.

With Aquarius strength is often in independence. A brighter violet underlines it.

Shadow being different for ever

In the shadow Aquarius learns to guard its difference so carefully that it cannot be rid of it even when it wants to.

Aquarius sometimes feels different. Violet can strengthen this feeling of difference even more.

And when being different is the only role, there is hardly room left in it for the ordinary.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **allow yourself to be ordinary now and then**, and explain it to nobody.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add white or silver for calm.

white · silver · cream

One unexpected accent. Let the rest be calm.

Aquarius as ascendant

When Aquarius is your ascendant, you come across as independent, a little unusual and friendly. People see you as an original personality who keeps their own space.

Violet adds a gentle touch to your independence. Brighter shades keep originality.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for **one striking piece** that nobody else has.*

When you feel alone, pair violet with something you share with others. A mug, a notebook.

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Pisces (19 February – 20 March)

Your violet

Lavender · blue-violet · soft heather

A violet that gives room to **dreams and transcendence**.

Pisces is linked with its traditional ruler Jupiter, water and the end of winter. It is sensitive and spiritual. Violet gives you room for dreams and transcendence. According to some sources it also belongs to your ruler Jupiter, and so it may feel **like home**.

What Pisces is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter, in the newer view also Neptune

Pisces is **empathic**, intuitive and dreamy. It picks up the moods around it and often has a rich imagination. It frequently has a bond with art, music and spirituality.

Its strength is **compassion** and creative fantasy. The weaker side tends to be merging with other people's feelings, escaping into dreams and difficulty setting boundaries.

What it can support in you

Violet can support moments when you need to quiet down and dream. It suits soft fabrics and dusk.

With Pisces strength is often in empathy. Lavender carries it without weight.

Shadow losing the ground under your feet

In the shadow Pisces drifts so far that it loses contact with what is around. Violet then becomes a colour with nowhere left to land.

Pisces drifts easily. Too much violet can pull you away from the ground and from reality.

And when everything is a dream, it is hard to tell what needs doing today.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **take one concrete task** and a mug of something warm.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add brown and green for grounding.

brown · green · Jupiter blue

Wood, a plant, clay. Earth under your feet, and above it a violet dusk.

Pisces as ascendant

When Pisces is your ascendant, you come across as gentle, dreamy and adaptable. People like to project their wishes onto you and tend to be kind to you.

Violet adds depth to your gentleness. Lavender and heather keep the lightness.

In everyday life

*Keep violet for **quiet moments** when you allow yourself to dream, and then add a piece of earth.*

When you get lost, put a hand on something brown or green and take a deep breath.

FOR A DEEPER LOOK

- **Seasons**

Violet is the colour of lilac in spring, lavender in summer and plums in autumn. Each season carries it a little differently. Ask yourself when you reach for it.

- **Time of day**

Dusk is the moment when the sky turns violet. Violet suits it. In the morning it can feel heavy.

- **Years of life**

Jupiter orbits the Sun in roughly 12 years. Astrology speaks of its returns at roughly 12, 24, 36, 48 and 60 years and reads them as times of soaring and a search for meaning. In these years violet may feel close to you, or on the contrary foreign. Both are natural. Research by Palmer and Schloss (2010) also reports that we like colours according to the things and experiences we associate with them. Astrology does not rule this out, it just offers another view.

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Colour for your website and business

Yes – but more as a mysterious spark than as the main voice.

In business violet is a colour that asks for attention, but **quietly**. It acts like a person wearing something nobody else picked, and it still suits them. It is creative, luxurious and a little mysterious, and that is why it is good to know what it promises before you let it into a logo, a website or an advertisement.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help create a **distinctive impression**, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Violet can say, for example

"This is exceptional." "It is personal." "Here you can create." "It matters."

- **Luxury and rarity.** Violet long cost more than silver, and that stays with us. The customer reads that there is something exceptional here.
- **Creativity and originality.** It is linked with ideas, art and an unconventional approach.
- **Femininity and playfulness.** In combination with pink it is linked with femininity and sensuality.
- **Spirituality and depth.** It suits where you offer silence, transcendence or inner work.
- **Showiness.** Sometimes it is also linked with vanity. Beware of overdoing it.

Depending on the shade, though, it can also act differently. Lavender is **gentle and caring**, plum and wine **luxurious**, a rich violet **creative and striking**.

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Simple tips

As an accent, not a wall

It suits as the colour of a logo, button or detail. Mute large areas and balance them with light.

Shade by role

Lavender for gentleness and care, plum and wine for luxury, a rich violet for creativity and expression.

Combinations

Gold for prestige, white for purity, green for a natural contrast, yellow (its counterpart) for energy.

Cultural context

In Europe violet is luxury and the church, in Thailand the mourning of widows, in Japan nobility, in the women's movement a voice. Before you head out into the world, find out what violet means where you are and where they are.

Legibility

A light lavender on white is almost illegible. Use a darker shade and check the contrast.

Colour blindness

About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Do not use these two colours as the only difference between two things.

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Professions where it is a Yes

The rule is simple. When you sell exceptionality, creativity and depth, violet will help you.

Cosmetics, fragrance, jewellery and personal care

Soft tones can accompany a more sensitive and personal expression, deeper shades feel more festive or sensual. **Let them tie in with a real material, scent or character of the service.** A lavender pack suggests itself where lavender has its place. It does not have to accompany every product just because it should give a calming impression.

Fashion, art and original work

It suits a gallery, a music project, a theatre or a distinctive personal brand. Try it as a frame for real photographs and works. **If a violet filter covers everything**, a visitor may recognise your colour, but no longer your work.

Wellness, meditation, coaching and therapy

Violet can be an understandable part of their symbolism, and that is exactly why it is good to watch the amount of other signs. A violet background, gold lettering, stars, a lotus and three glowing circles can already convey more mystery than a person needs when looking for a course date. **Let a visitor easily find out what you offer, who it is for and what she will actually experience there.**

Publishing, education, confectionery and culture

Luxury confectionery, festivals and cultural events have relied on violet since long ago. So has the personal brand of a woman who wants to show her own style.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Banks, insurers and technical fields.** Where you sell austere reliability, a mysterious colour can distract.
- **Crisis and health help.** Over-mysterious styling can overshadow the concreteness and clarity of the service.
- **Operating information and long text.** Muted shades or a rich violet in the background are hard to read.
- **Presentation of colour-sensitive products.** Violet lighting or a filter can distort their real look.

Give important information clearly legible dark text.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the violet?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that violet means luxury.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know violet from chocolate, couriers and whisky. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Cadbury (chocolate)**
  The company launched Dairy Milk chocolate in 1905 and gave it a violet wrapper in 1914, in memory of Queen Victoria. A dispute with Nestlé over exclusive rights to a shade of violet ran into 2012 and 2013 and Cadbury did not manage to keep protection of the shade. The colour still became its signature.
- **Milka (chocolate)**
  Alpine chocolate Milka was created in 1901 at the Swiss maker Suchard. The violet and the violet cow from the adverts made it a brand you recognise even without the name.
- **FedEx (courier services)**
  Since 1994 the company has carried the name FedEx and a violet-and-orange logo. Violet here means reliability and size, orange energy. Between the E and the x in the logo hides an arrow pointing forward.
- **Crown Royal (whisky)**
  The Canadian whisky was created in 1939 for the visit of King George VI to Canada. A violet velvet bag with a gold drawstring makes it a gift that carries a feeling of royal celebration.

What they share is that violet carries a simple message. **Celebration, rarity, exceptionality**. And it is mostly not everywhere, only where it should stand out.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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Different colour combinations

Violet + red

How it feels

Two from one colour. Violet is made from red and blue, so red is its relative. Together they make a rich, warm pair (burgundy, plum). Red warms violet and violet calms red.

When it suits

When you want **passion with depth**, but not shouting.

Specific shades



violet + red
deeply



plum + wine
sensually



lavender + terracotta
softly



bright violet + scarlet
dramatically



grey-violet + brick
earthily

In practice

A plum jumper and red lipstick. A wine wall and a violet cushion.

Watch out

Large areas of both can feel **heavy**.

Violet + orange

How it feels

Sunset. Orange and violet meet in the sky just after sunset, when orange fades and the sky turns violet. Orange lights violet up and violet calms orange.

When it suits

When you want to **light up** a darker whole.

Specific shades



violet + orange
radiantly



plum + pumpkin
richly



lavender + apricot
softly



grey-violet + terracotta
earthily



lilac + peach
gently

In practice

A violet scarf and an orange lamp. A plum wall with an orange accessory.

Watch out

A rich orange on a large area overpowers violet. An **accent** is enough.

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Violet + yellow

How it feels

The counterpart. Yellow stands opposite violet on the colour wheel, and that is why their contrast is the strongest. Gold on an evening sky, saffron on lilac.

When it suits

When you want **one light spot** in the middle of depth.

Specific shades


violet + lemon
strikingly


plum + golden
festively


lavender + buttery
springlike


grey-violet + mustard
earthily


lilac + vanilla
gently

In practice

A yellow accessory in a lavender room. A yellow candle and a violet blanket.

Watch out

When there is too much yellow, it can **disturb**. Add yellow by the tip of the brush.

Violet + green

How it feels

A flower among leaves. Green and violet together look like lilac or lavender in a garden. They were also two of the three colours of the suffragettes.

When it suits

When you want a **natural contrast**.

Specific shades


violet + green
naturally


plum + bottle green
deeply


lavender + sage
airily


grey-violet + olive
earthily


lilac + mint
freshly

In practice

A violet scarf and a green plant. Lavender in green ceramics.

Watch out

Watch the proportion and richness. Two richly contrasting areas can **tug against each other**.

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Violet + blue

How it feels

Relatives. Blue is one of the colours violet is made from. Together they look calm and deep. Blue cools violet and violet softens blue.

When it suits

When you want **calm with transcendence**.

Specific shades



violet + blue
calmly



plum + navy
deeply



lavender + sky blue
airily



bright violet + cobalt
freshly



grey-violet + washed denim
soberly

In practice

Lavender and light blue in a bedroom. A violet scarf and jeans.

Watch out

Both are cooler. Without warmth the whole can feel **cold**.

Violet + indigo

How it feels

Dusk. Indigo is violet's nearest neighbour in the rainbow. Together they recall an evening sky approaching night. Indigo deepens violet.

When it suits

When you want **depth without shouting**.

Specific shades



violet + indigo
at dusk



plum + ultramarine
deeply



lavender + dusk
gently



bright violet + indigo
richly



grey-violet + grey indigo
soberly

In practice

An indigo coat and a violet scarf. A dark blue-violet in a library.

Watch out

Two deep colours side by side easily merge. Add a **light point**.

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Violet + pink

How it feels

A softer face. Pink is a lighter relative of red, and so with violet it makes a gentle, sensual pair. Violet deepens pink, pink softens violet.

When it suits

When you want **tenderness and playfulness**.

Specific shades



violet + pink
playfully



plum + raspberry
sensually



lavender + powder pink
tenderly



lilac + blossom
springlike



grey-violet + dusty rose
dustily

In practice

Lilac and powder pink on cushions. Plum and pink in a piece of jewellery.

Watch out

A whole that is too sugary can feel **cloying**. Add a neutral colour.

Violet + grey

How it feels

Elegant calm. Grey mutes violet and makes it urban. Together they look sober and a little stormy.

When it suits

When you want **elegance** without showiness.

Specific shades



violet + grey
soberly



plum + graphite
elegantly



lavender + silver
lightly



bright violet + slate
modernly



grey-violet + dove grey
quietly

In practice

A grey blazer and a violet scarf. A grey wall and a lavender throw.

Watch out

A cold grey with a cool violet can feel **cold**. Try a warmer material.

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Violet + brown

How it feels

Earth under your feet. Brown grounds violet. Together they look like plums in a wooden bowl or heather in autumn.

When it suits

When you want **violet with earth**.

Specific shades



violet + brown
earthily



plum + chocolate
deeply



lavender + beige
softly



heather + caramel
autumnally



grey-violet + linen
naturally

In practice

A wooden table and a violet cushion. A brown coat and a plum scarf.

Watch out

Two dark colours can merge. Add a **light accent**.

Violet + white

How it feels

A clean sheet. White brightens violet and gives it space. Together they recall lilac in spring and the suffragettes.

When it suits

When you want **purity and light**.

Specific shades



violet + white
cleanly



plum + cream
elegantly



lavender + snow white
freshly



bright violet + white
strikingly



grey-violet + lilac white
gently

In practice

A white kitchen with violet ceramics. A white shirt and a violet scarf.

Watch out

A pair with too much contrast can feel **austere**.

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Violet + black

How it feels

Evening depth. Black and dark violet are very close. An elegant but heavy pair.

When it suits

When you want **evening elegance**.

Specific shades

violet + black
mysteriously

plum + charcoal
deeply

aubergine + graphite
soberly

bright violet + black
dramatically

grey-violet + black
unobtrusively

In practice

A black dress and a violet scarf. A blackboard and a lavender detail.

Watch out

When there is too much, **light** is missing. Add white or gold.

Violet + gold

How it feels

A royal pair. Violet and gold have belonged together since the days of purple and imperial robes. Gold lights violet up and violet gives gold depth.

When it suits

When you want **festivity and prestige**.

Specific shades

violet + gold
festively

plum + antique gold
richly

lavender + champagne
gently

grey-violet + matte gold
subtly

lilac + pale gold
airily

In practice

A gold piece of jewellery on a plum jumper. Violet packaging with gold lettering.

Watch out

In excess gold **drowns out ordinary comfort**. A detail is enough.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **soften** violet, add **white**, **cream**, **lavender** or **grey**.
- When you want to **ground** it, add **brown**, **green**, **wood** or **natural materials**.
- When you want to **light it up**, add **yellow**, **orange** or **gold**.
- When you want to **deepen** it, **plum**, **wine** or **black** will help.

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